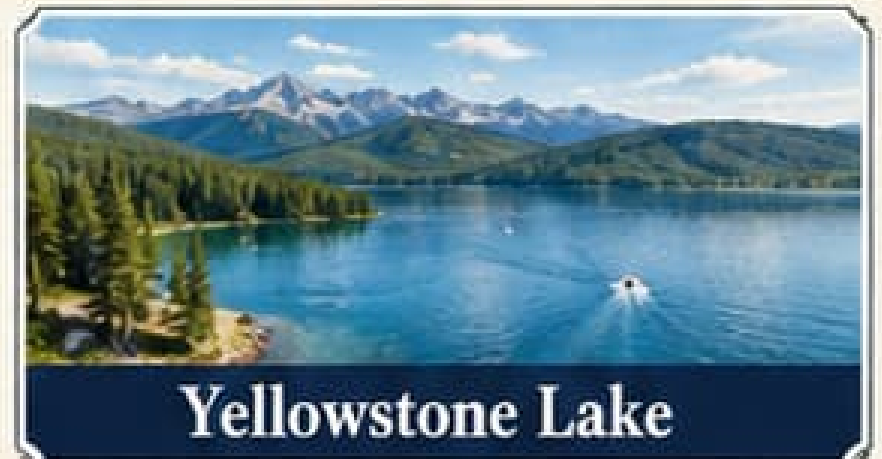


Yellowstone & Grand Teton

Road Trip

Salt Lake City Loop | June 14, 2026 – June 20, 2026

Salt Lake City → Grand Teton → Yellowstone → Idaho Falls → Salt Lake City



Lodging Sequence

- 6/14–6/15: Victor / Driggs
- 6/16–6/17: Island Park
- 6/18: Gardiner
- 6/19: Idaho Falls



Trip Highlights

- Jenny Lake short hike
- Grand Prismatic
- Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone
- Lamar Valley wildlife viewing
- Yellowstone Lake southbound crossing

Master Itinerary

Salt Lake City Loop | June 14, 2026 – June 20, 2026

Date	Start & Drive In	Attractions & In-Park Commute	Lodging	End & Drive Out
6/14	SLC 11:00 AM pickup, 11:30 AM lunch + supplies, 1:00 PM depart, 4.5–5.5 hr to Grand Teton area	Schwabacher Landing short walk 20–45 min → 0.2–0.3 hr drive → Mormon Row 20–30 min	Victor / Driggs	Over Teton Pass, 0.75–1 hr
6/15	Victor / Driggs → Jenny Lake, 0.75–1.2 hr	Jenny Lake boat / wait 0.75–1 hr → Hidden Falls + Inspiration Point 1.5 hr → Cascade Canyon short out-and-back 2 hr → Oxbow Bend 0.5 hr	Victor / Driggs	Return over the pass, 1–1.5 hr
6/16	Victor / Driggs → north through Grand Teton → Yellowstone Southwest, 3.5–4.5 hr	Old Faithful + Upper Geyser Basin 2.5–3 hr → 0.3 hr drive → Grand Prismatic Overlook / Fairy Falls Trail 1.5 hr	Island Park	West Entrance to Island Park, 1–1.25 hr
6/17	Island Park → Norris, 1.25–1.75 hr	Norris 1.5 hr → 0.5 hr drive → Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone / Artist Point 2 hr → 0.5 hr drive → Hayden Valley 1–1.5 hr	Island Park	Return via West Entrance, 1.5–2 hr
6/18	Island Park → Mammoth Hot Springs, 2.5–3 hr	Mammoth Hot Springs 1.5 hr → North Entrance out 0.3 hr → Gardiner check-in / dinner 1.5 hr → 1 hr drive → Lamar Valley 1.5–2 hr	Gardiner	Lamar Valley back to Gardiner, 1–1.25 hr
6/19	Gardiner → Yellowstone Lake / West Thumb area, 2.5–3.5 hr	Yellowstone Lake scenic stops 0.5 hr → 0.5 hr drive → West Thumb 1 hr → 0.5 hr drive to South Entrance	Idaho Falls	South Entrance to Idaho Falls, 2.5–3.5 hr
6/20	Idaho Falls → SLC, 3–3.5 hr	No in-park activities	Salt Lake City airport / city	Return rental car and depart

Times are normal-condition estimates. Yellowstone traffic, parking, and wildlife may cause delays.

Day 1 | June 14

First Look at Grand Teton

Depart after lunch and supplies in Salt Lake City | Light evening walk and photo stops



Today's Driving

- Pickup 11:00 AM
- Lunch + supplies 11:30 AM
- Depart 1:00 PM
- Drive in 4.5–5.5 hr
- Drive out 0.75–1 hr



Park Rhythm

- Mostly a short walk day
- 0.2–0.3 hr between stops



Lodging

- Victor / Driggs



Schwabacher Landing



Mormon Row



Evening road views
in Grand Teton



Today's Sequence

- 1 SLC rental pickup and lunch / supplies
- 2 Schwabacher Landing short walk — 20–45 min
- 3 Mormon Row — 20–30 min



Today's Highlight

After a long transfer day, this is the easiest way to enjoy your first views of Grand Teton. Focus on mountain scenery, reflections, and evening light.



Tip

This is not a real hiking day. If arrival is late, keep only Mormon Row or go directly to Victor / Driggs.

Day 2 | June 15 | Jenny Lake & Cascade Canyon

Jenny Lake boat | Hidden Falls | Inspiration Point
Cascade Canyon | Oxbow Bend



Today's Driving

Drive in 0.75–1.2 hr
Drive out 1–1.5 hr



In-Park Commute

About 0.5 hr
between stops



Lodging

Victor / Driggs



Jenny Lake



Hidden Falls /
Inspiration Point



Oxbow Bend



Today's Sequence

- 1 Jenny Lake boat / wait 0.75–1 hr
- 2 Hidden Falls + Inspiration Point 1.5 hr
- 3 Cascade Canyon short out-and-back 2 hr
- 4 Oxbow Bend at evening light 0.5 hr



Today's Highlight

This is the core Grand Teton day, combining classic lake scenery with the most worthwhile short hike of the trip.



Tip

Do not go too deep into Cascade Canyon. This day already includes hiking, and you still need to drive back over Teton Pass to Victor / Driggs.

Day 3 | June 16 | Yellowstone Southwest

Old Faithful | Upper Geyser Basin | Grand Prismatic Overlook



Today's Driving

Drive in 3.5–4.5 hr
Drive out 1–1.25 hr



In-Park Commute

About 0.3 hr



Lodging

Island Park



Old Faithful



Grand Prismatic Overlook



Upper Geyser Basin



Today's Sequence

1 Old Faithful + Upper
Geyser Basin
2.5–3 hr

2 Grand Prismatic Overlook /
Fairy Falls Trail
1.5 hr



Today's Highlight

This is your first full day
in Yellowstone, focused
on the park's most iconic
geothermal scenery.



Tip

Geothermal areas and
crowds already make
this a full day.
Do not add too many
small extra stops.

Day 4 | June 17 | Yellowstone Lower Loop

Norris | Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone | Artist Point | Hayden Valley



Today's Driving

- Drive in 1.25–1.75 hr
- Drive out 1.5–2 hr



In-Park Commute

About 1 hr total



Lodging

Island Park



Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone



Norris Geyser Basin



Hayden Valley wildlife



Today's Sequence

- 1 Norris Geyser Basin — 1.5 hr
- 2 Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone / Artist Point — 2 hr
- 3 Hayden Valley wildlife viewing — 1–1.5 hr



Today's Highlight

This is the most varied day of the trip, with geothermal scenery, canyon views, waterfalls, and wildlife all in one day.



Tip

Do not stay too late in Hayden Valley. The drive back to Island Park can feel long after dark.

Day 5 | June 18 | Yellowstone North Transfer Day

Mammoth Hot Springs | Gardiner | Lamar Valley



Today's Driving

- Drive in 2.5–3 hr
- Drive out 1–1.25 hr



In-Park Commute

- About 1.3 hr



Lodging

- Gardiner



Mammoth Hot Springs



Lamar Valley



Yellowstone north road and wildlife viewing



Today's Sequence

- 1 Mammoth Hot Springs — 1.5 hr
- 2 Gardiner check-in / dinner — 1.5 hr
- 3 Lamar Valley wildlife viewing — 1.5–2 hr



Today's Highlight

Mammoth Hot Springs has unique terraces, while evening in Lamar Valley is one of the best wildlife-viewing windows of the entire trip.



Tip Lamar Valley is mainly a drive-and-watch experience. Wildlife sightings are never guaranteed, so returning to Gardiner around dusk is the safest plan.

Day 6 | June 19 | Yellowstone Lake Southbound Crossing

Yellowstone Lake | West Thumb | South Entrance | Idaho Falls



Today's Driving

Drive in 2.5–3.5 hr
Drive out 2.5–3.5 hr



In-Park Commute

About 1 hr



Lodging

Idaho Falls



Yellowstone Lake



West Thumb Geyser Basin



Southbound road and lake views



Today's Sequence

- 1 Yellowstone Lake scenic stops — 0.5 hr
- 2 West Thumb Geyser Basin — 1 hr
- 3 Exit via South Entrance and continue south to Idaho Falls



Today's Highlight

This day is mainly about the long drive and a few final scenic stops. The highlights are Yellowstone Lake and the lakeside geothermal scenery at West Thumb.



Tip

This is one of the most tiring days of the trip. Do not add a long hike — keep it focused on driving, lake views, and a few final stops.

Day 7 | June 20 | Return Day

Idaho Falls → Salt Lake City | Easy finish



Today's Driving:

Idaho Falls →
Salt Lake City, 3–3.5 hr



Today's Plan:

Highway return;
no in-park activities



Finish:

Salt Lake City
airport / city



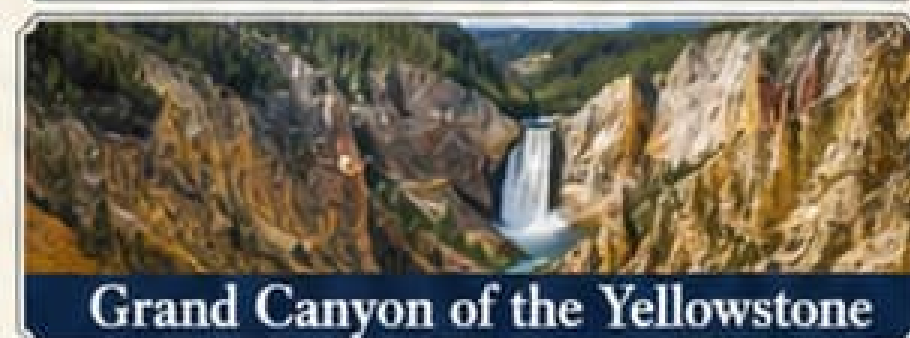
Trip Recap



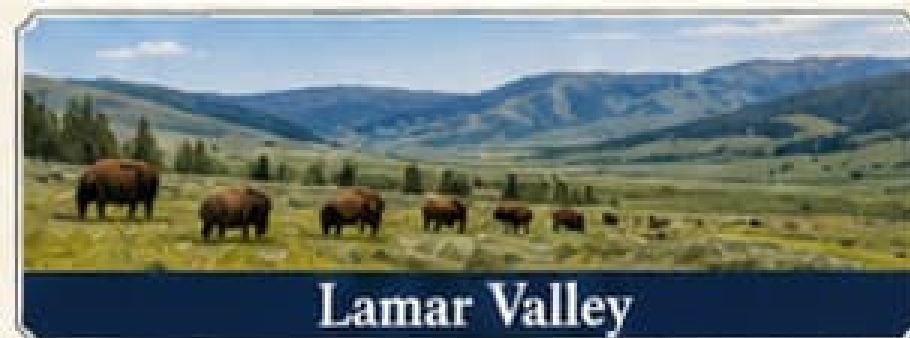
Grand Teton



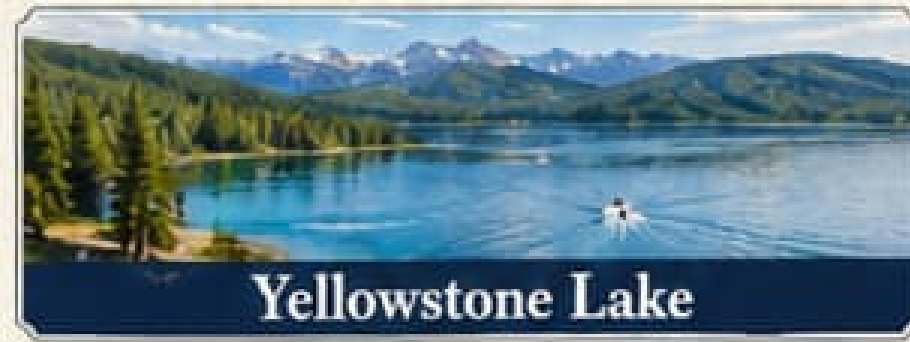
Old Faithful



Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone



Lamar Valley



Yellowstone Lake



Today's Sequence

- 1 Drive south on I-15 back to Salt Lake City
- 2 Return rental car, organize luggage, and prepare to depart



Today's Highlight

This is the lightest-paced day, making it a good time to sort photos, look back on the trip, and wrap everything up without stress.



Trip Recap

This loop covers Grand Teton mountain-and-lake scenery, Yellowstone geothermal landmarks, the Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone, Lamar Valley wildlife viewing, and Yellowstone Lake. The pace is full, but the core sights are covered well.

